
Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

2024 Stack Overflow Survey

65,437 respondents across 180+ countries

Source: Stack Overflow Developer Survey 2024 | survey.stackoverflow.co/2024

84% of Developers Are Working, but Full-Time Employment Dips in the U.S.

U.S. full-time employment dropped 4.2pp year-over-year (69% → 64.8%), signaling a shift toward contractors

Global Employment Status



U.S. Full-Time Trend



Key Insight

Globally, 84% of 65,437 respondents are currently working.
Freelancing and contracting remain significant at 16%+.

Regional Patterns

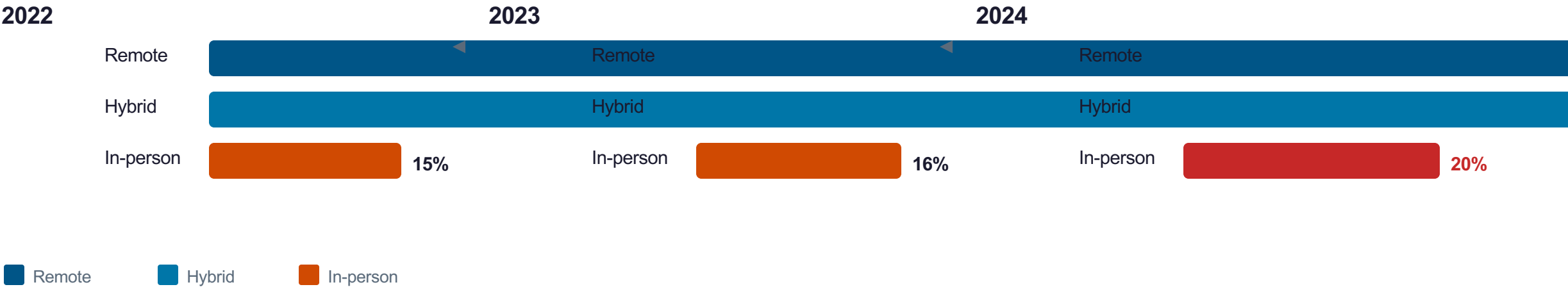
U.K. & Ukraine lean toward contracting; Germany & India have more full-time students.

Source: Stack Overflow Developer Survey 2024 | n=65,437 respondents

In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%

Third consecutive year of in-person growth (15% → 16% → 20%), but hybrid remains the dominant mode

Work Environment Trend: 2022 → 2024



Remote Declining
Dropped 5pp from 2022 (43% → 38%)
as return-to-office policies expand

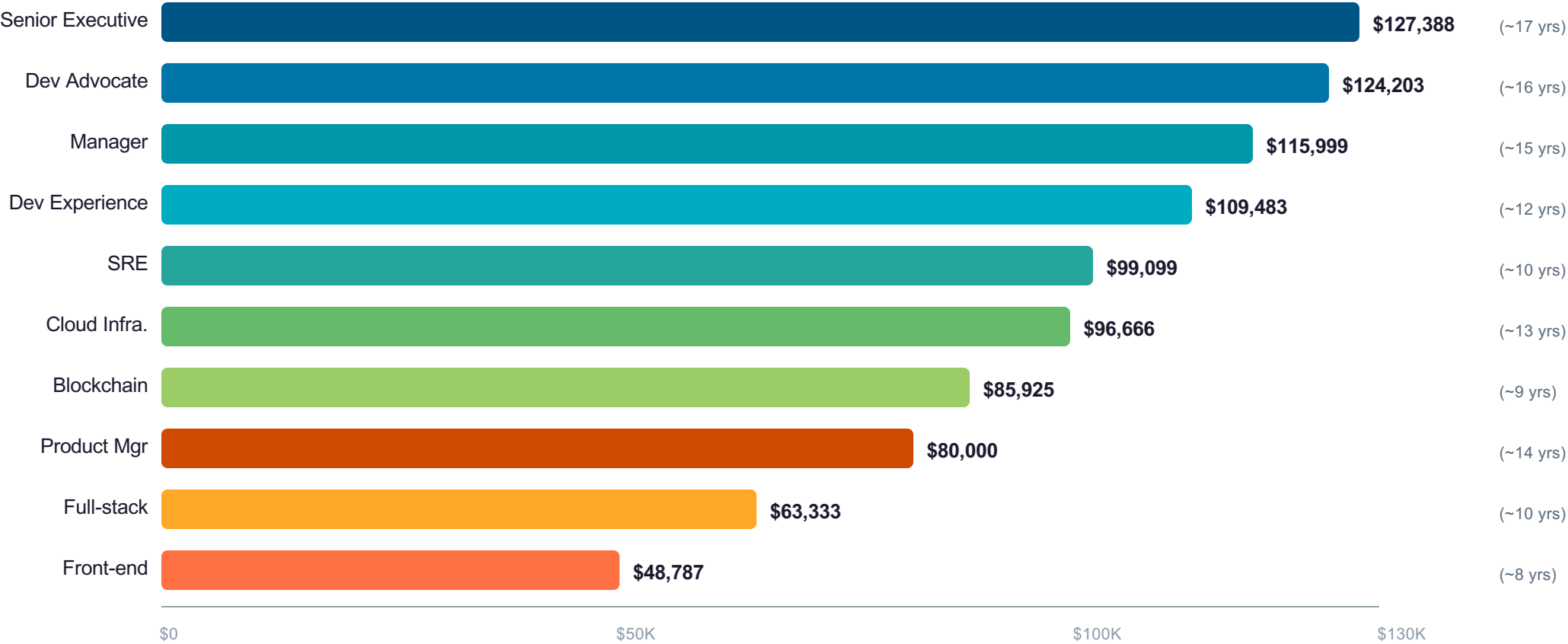
Hybrid Stable
42% in 2024, consistent with 2023
— remains the most common arrangement

In-Person Rising
Third consecutive year of growth
15% → 16% → 20% signals RTO trend

Source: Stack Overflow Developer Survey 2024

Senior Executives and Dev Advocates Top \$124K+ Median Salary

DevRel and leadership roles command premium pay — all top 3 roles have 15+ years average experience

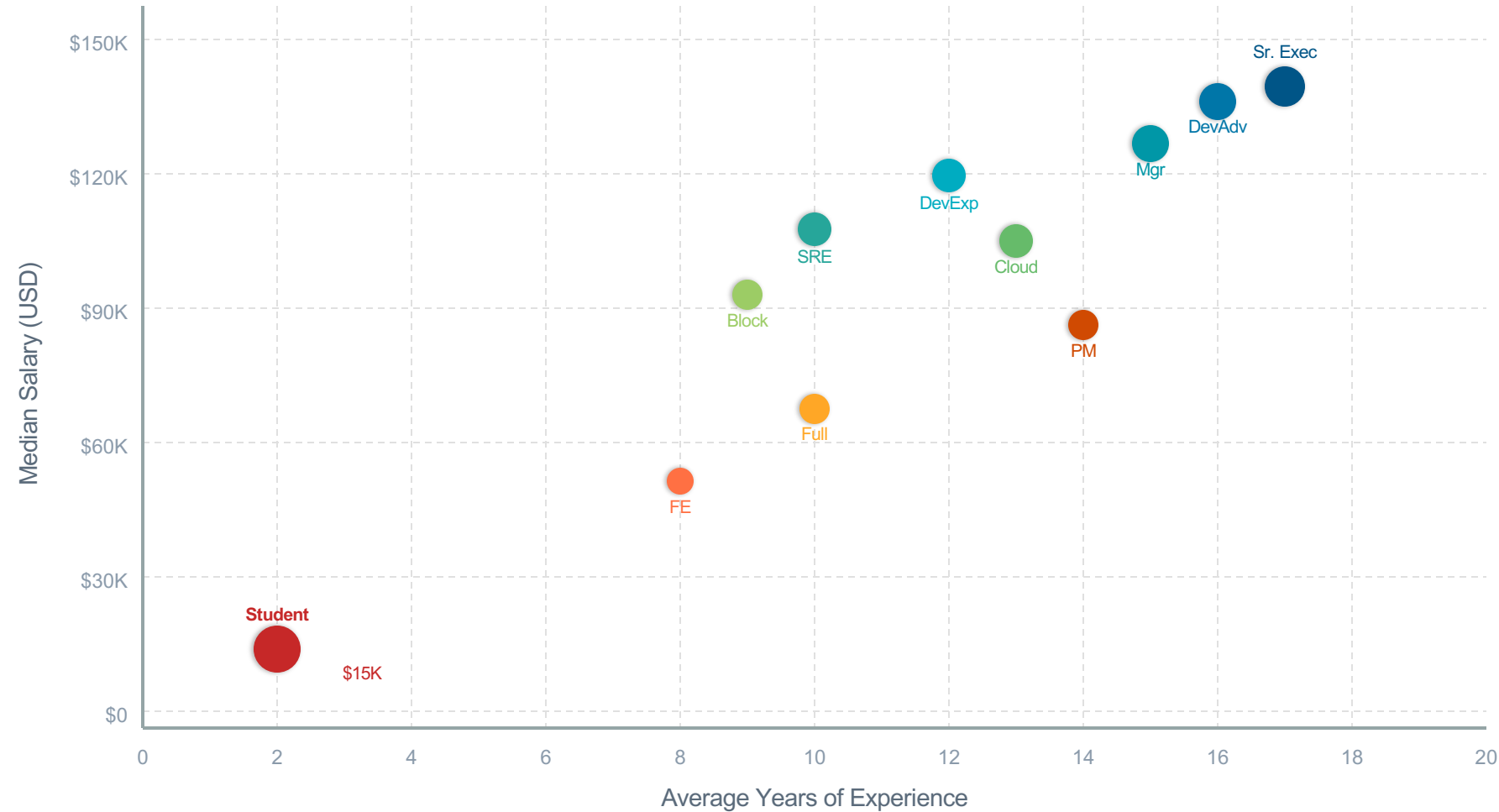


Note: Median annual compensation (USD). Data from 22,677 salary responses (34.7% response rate). See figure_1.jpg for reference chart.

Regional Variations
Mobile devs earn more in the U.S. • Data engineers top charts in Germany & Ukraine

Experience Pays: Top Roles Combine 14+ Years with Six-Figure Salaries

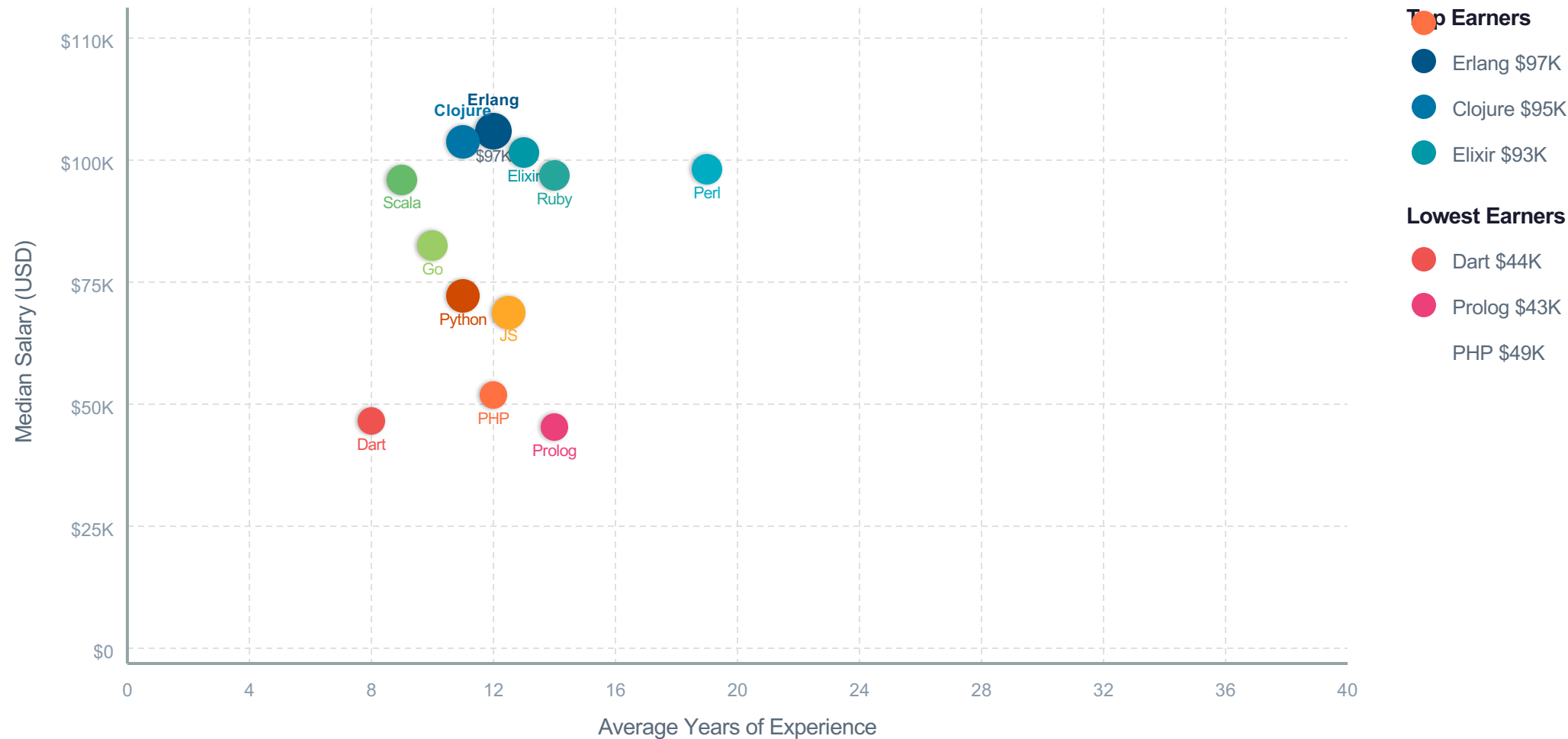
Senior roles cluster in upper-right (\$100K+ salary, 14+ years exp); Student is a clear outlier at \$15K



Reference: figure_2.jpg | Bubble size represents number of responses | Upper-right cluster: high exp + high salary

Erlang & Clojure Developers Earn >\$95K; Dart & Prolog Below \$45K

Niche functional languages correlate with higher pay — overall salary range dropped ~\$10K vs 2023



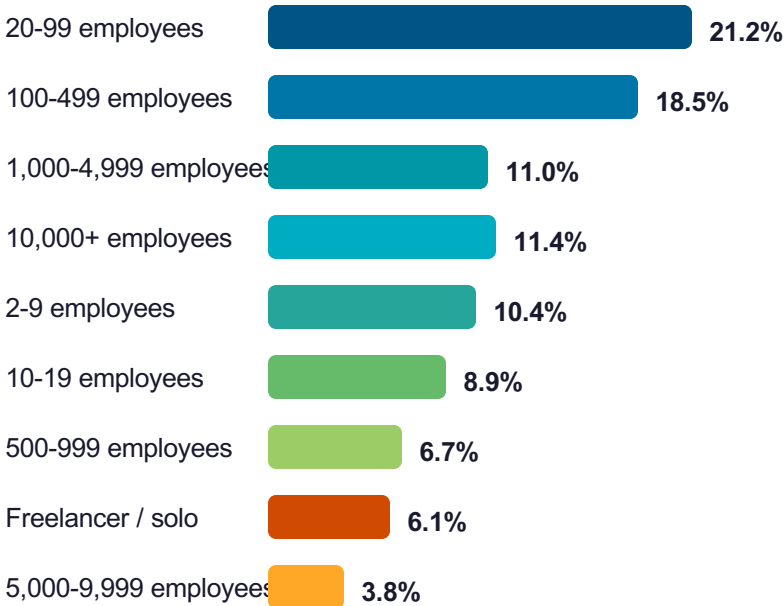
Note: Overall salary range dropped ~\$10K vs 2023 (\$60-75K avg vs \$70-85K). See figure_3.jpg for reference.

47% Work at Sub-100 Orgs; 62% Influence Tech Purchases

Developers are key purchase influencers — 62% have a say in tech buying decisions

Company Size Distribution

n=42,827 respondents



47% work at orgs with <100 employees

Technology Purchasing Influence

62% of developers influence tech purchases

Influence by Role



Evaluation Preferences

60% prefer build-and-buy approach

Top evaluation methods:

- 75% start with free trials
- 73% ask other developers

Takeaways: What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

1. Full-time employment softening

U.S. full-time dropped 4.2pp YoY (69% → 64.8%). Plan for a more contractor-heavy workforce. Freelancing remains at 16%+.

2. In-person mandates growing

Hybrid still dominant at 42%, but in-person rising (15%→20%). Prepare for hybrid/remote policies as differentiator.

3. DevRel and SRE command premium

Dev Advocates (\$124K), SRE (\$99K), Cloud Infra (\$97K) earn top dollar. Budget accordingly for these critical roles.

4. Niche languages pay more

Erlang, Clojure, Elixir developers earn >\$93K median. Mainstream languages (JS, PHP) sit well below \$65K.

5. Developers influence purchasing — engage them directly

62% of developers influence tech buying. Senior executives (99%), engineering managers (87%), and PMs (77%) wield the most influence. 68% prefer build and buy. Top evaluation methods: free trials (75%) and peer recommendations (72%).

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